



RIPOSTE LABORATORIES – BRAND & DESIGN SYSTEM

DOC NO. RL-BRAND-001-A REV. A RIPOSTE LABORATORIES

This is the single source of truth for how Riposte Laboratories Inc. looks, reads and behaves – on the website, in a deck, in a README, on a sticker, in Canva, in Figma, in a printed spec sheet. If two things disagree, this repo wins.

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EST. 2026

Parry. Riposte.

The aesthetic, in one line: **industrial spec-sheet × jester mi-parti**. Everything is drawn like a numbered technical document on bone paper, then cut through with harlequin pink, marigold and teal.

SEC.01

THE FIVE RULES

If you remember nothing else, remember these. Every page in this repo is downstream of them.

#	RULE	WHY
1	Ink on bone. #1d1a17 on #f6f1e7. Not black on white.	The warmth is the difference between a lab document and a tax form.
2	Accents rotate. pink → marigold → teal, in that order, forever.	They are equal citizens. Picking a favourite collapses the harlequin into a corporate accent colour.
3	Radius 0. Everywhere. No exceptions.	Sharp corners are the brand. The only curves in the system belong to the logo.
4	No blur. No soft shadows, no glows, no gradients except the three functional patterns. Depth comes from a hard 4px 4px 0 offset.	The system is drawn , not lit.
5	One font. JetBrains Mono, weights 400 / 700 / 800.	Hierarchy comes from size, weight, case and tracking – never from a second family.

SEC.02

START HERE

I WANT TO...	GO TO
Set up the brand in Canva	tools/canva.md RL-BRAND-001-CANVA
Set up Figma	tools/figma.md RL-BRAND-001-FIGMA
Set up Google Docs / Slides	tools/google-workspace.md RL-BRAND-001-GWS
Set up Word / PowerPoint	tools/office.md RL-BRAND-001-OFFICE
Set up Illustrator / Affinity / Photoshop	tools/adobe-affinity.md RL-BRAND-001-ADOBE
Set up Inkscape / GIMP / Krita	tools/inkscape-gimp.md RL-BRAND-001-FOSS
Build a website or app	tools/web.md RL-BRAND-001-WEB
Get a thing printed	docs/08-print.md RL-BRAND-001-PRINT
Look up an exact colour value	docs/color-reference.md RL-BRAND-001-COLOR-REFERENCE
See it all rendered	specimen/index.html – open in a browser

Deep reference: colour[RL-BRAND-001-COLOR](#) · type[RL-BRAND-001-TYPE](#) · spacing[RL-BRAND-001-SPACE](#) · logo[RL-BRAND-001-LOGO](#) · patterns[RL-BRAND-001-PAT](#)
 · voice[RL-BRAND-001-VOICE](#) · accessibility[RL-BRAND-001-A11Y](#) · print[RL-BRAND-001-PRINT](#) · document numbers[RL-BRAND-001-DOCNO](#)

SEC.03

THE PALETTE AT A GLANCE

Hex is normative. Every other notation is derived from it – see [docs/color-reference.md](#)[RL-BRAND-001-COLOR-REFERENCE](#) for RGB / HSL / OKLCH / CMYK on every token, plus the full contrast matrix.

BASE – INK & PAPER

	TOKEN	HEX	USE
■	ink	#1D1A17	All text, all 2px rules, the dark field
■	ink-raised	#241F1B	Panel surface on a dark field
■	ink-head	#2B2723	Header fill on a dark field
■	ink-line	#5C554C	Dashed dividers on a dark field. Never text.
□	bone	#F6F1E7	The paper. Default background
□	bone-dim	#EAE4D6	Recessed paper: sunken panels, spec headers
□	white	#FFFFFF	One hero field per site. That's the whole budget

ACCENTS – THE MI-PARTI THREE

Rotate them. `nth-child(3n)` / `nth-child(4n)` across repeated elements.

	TOKEN	HEX	TEXT ON IT
■	pink	#F0477D	bone
■	orange	#FE9A0D	ink – the exception, and the reason marigold exists
■	teal	#12B795	bone

ACCENTS, DEEP – FOR WHEN AN ACCENT MUST CARRY A sentence

Same hue, same saturation, lightness dropped until bone text clears WCAG AA. The bright three above are for fills, bars, chips and large uppercase display. The moment a coloured surface has to hold body copy, switch to these.

	TOKEN	HEX	BONE ON IT
	pink-deep	#D81150	4.53:1 ✓ AA
	orange-deep	#A15E01	4.53:1 ✓ AA
	teal-deep	#0C7A63	4.69:1 ✓ AA
	teal-ink	#04463A	4.24:1 on teal – AA Large only; short diagram labels

The honest caveat. bone on pink is 3.16:1 and bone on teal is 2.27:1. Both are **brand-correct** and both **fail** AA for body text. They are legal on chips, spec headers, section bars and uppercase display type at 24px+ – which is exactly where the production site uses them. They are not legal on a paragraph. docs/07-accessibility.md RL-BRAND-001-A11Y has the full story.

SEC.04

TYPE

JetBrains Mono – one family, three weights (400 / 700 / 800), SIL OFL licensed, free to embed and redistribute. jetbrains.com/lp/mono

There is no second family. The spec-sheet feel comes from a single mono voice used at different sizes, weights, cases and tracking. Headings are UPPERCASE; prose is sentence case; the smaller and more "machine" the text, the wider the tracking.

STEP	SIZE	CASE	TRACKING	USE
display	clamp(30px, 6.6vw, 74px)	UPPER	-.01em	Slide and hero statements
h1	clamp(30px, 5vw, 54px)	UPPER	.03em	Page heads
h2	clamp(24px, 3.2vw, 40px)	UPPER	.03em	Section headings
h3	clamp(20px, 2.6vw, 30px)	UPPER	.03em	Sub-sections
lead	clamp(16px, 2vw, 19px) 700	sentence	0	Lead paragraphs
body	15px (16px homepage)	sentence	0	Prose. Max 66ch
md	14px	sentence	0	Spec body, secondary prose
nav	12px	UPPER	.08em	Nav, SEC chips, tags
label	11px	UPPER	.1em	Kickers, spec headers, corner marks
xs	10px	UPPER	.12em	Chip micro-labels

Full rules, including the tracking ladder and the letterspaced wordmark lockup: [docs/02-typography.md](#) RL-BRAND-001-TYPE.

In tools without JetBrains Mono: upload it (Canva Pro, Figma, Adobe all allow this – the OFL permits it). Only if you truly cannot: Space Mono → Roboto Mono → Consolas.

SEC.05

SPACING

A loose **2px grid**. Nine steps, and you should be able to justify any value that isn't one of them.

4px	8px	12px	16px	24px	34px	48px	64px	72px
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9

STEP	VALUE	WHERE IT GOES
1	4px	Chip padding, tight icon gaps
2	8px	Inline gaps, list item spacing
3	12px	Button padding (vertical), small card padding
4	16px	Default. Card padding, paragraph spacing
5	24px	Button padding (horizontal), gap between related blocks
6	34px	Column gap; the space under a section head
7	48px	Between major blocks inside a section
8	64px	Section padding, subpages
9	72px	Section padding, homepage

Containers – always viewport-capped so nothing touches the edge of a phone:

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
container	min(1060px, 92vw)	Standard section
container-wide	min(1160px, 94vw)	Table-of-contents + content layouts
container-prose	min(900px, 92vw)	Blog, single column
measure	66ch	Body copy max width (leads run 56-62ch)

The complete guide – vertical rhythm, the border-eats-padding rule, grid gutters, and how spacing changes on an ink field – is in [docs/03-spacing.md](#) RL-BRAND-

001-SPACE.

SEC.06

WHAT'S IN THIS REPO

brand/	
riposte-brand.css	← the drop-in stylesheet. Tokens + base + patterns.
tokens.json	← SOURCE OF TRUTH. Everything else is generated from this.
tokens.scss	generated
tailwind.preset.js	generated
palettes/	
riposte.ase	Adobe CC, Affinity, Sketch, Figma plugins
riposte.gpl	GIMP, Inkscape, Krita
riposte.sketchpalette	Sketch
riposte.csv	spreadsheets, print vendors, Canva copy-paste
riposte.json	scripts
assets/	
logo/	wordmark in ink / bone / pink, plus the harmonic marks
fonts/	self-hostable JetBrains Mono woff2 subsets
docs/	the deep reference
tools/	per-application setup recipes
specimen/index.html	the whole system rendered on one page
scripts/build.js	regenerates every export and verifies consistency

REGENERATING

`brand/tokens.json` is the only file you hand-edit for values. Then:

BASH

```
node scripts/build.js          # rewrite all exports, then verify
node scripts/build.js --check  # verify only; non-zero exit on drift
```

The verifier is not decorative. It fails the build if the stylesheet and `tokens.json` disagree on any hex, if a `-deep` accent stops clearing 4.5:1, if a `border-radius` other than 0 appears, if any shadow gains a blur radius, or if `riposte.ase` stops round-tripping.

It also resolves the `color-mix()` text tiers each field declares – `-text`, `-text-muted`, `-text-faint` – and fails if one stops being legible on its own background; and it checks that **every contrast figure printed anywhere in this repo** is a ratio the generated reference actually publishes, so a number cannot be invented, mistyped, or quietly attributed to the wrong pair. CI runs `-check` on every push.

SEC. 07

USING THIS IN ANOTHER RIPOSTE PROJECT

Every Riposte repo carries a `BRAND.md` stating how it applies this guide and what it deliberately doesn't. For anything with a web surface:

HTML

```
<link rel="stylesheet" href="https://ripostelabs.xyz/brand/riposte-brand.css">
```

...or vendor `brand/riposte-brand.css` into the project. Then close the page with the standard colophon:

HTML

```
<footer class="colophon">
  <div class="l">&copy; 2026 Riposte Laboratories Inc. &middot; All rights reserved.</div>
  <div class="r">parry &#9851; riposte &#9851; recycle &#9851; repeat</div>
</footer>
```

For documentation, use the brand colophon block at the foot of the README – see any Riposte `BRAND.md` for the exact form.

SEC.08

LICENCE

The **code and documentation** in this repo are MIT (see **LICENSE**).

The **Riposte Laboratories name, wordmark, esh figure and logo files in assets/logo/** are not covered by that licence. They are company marks – usable to refer to Riposte Laboratories, not to brand anything else.

JetBrains Mono is licensed under the SIL Open Font License 1.1 and is redistributed here under those terms; see **assets/fonts/README.md** RL-BRAND-001-FONT.

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poste Laboratories Inc.

SOURCE README.md SHA 6a51c21045c7 BUILT 2026-08-24